Matt Lebrun

Technical Education | Instructional Design | Mentorship

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Profile

I am a software engineer and educator. I design training around the problems people encounter and the work they want to do, drawing on my engineering experience to connect concepts with practical examples, discussion, and practice.

I have taught in professional workshops and undergraduate courses, mentored engineers, and worked with volunteers learning to lead. In each setting, I want people to understand enough to make their own decisions and continue learning beyond our time together.

Areas of practice

Technical curriculum design · Facilitation and training · Python and software development · Scaffolding and contextualized learning · Engineering mentorship · Community and volunteer development

Training and instructional design

CodeHappy | Co-founder and Principal Trainer

June 2018–present

Co-founded CodeHappy with Micaela Reyes, developing a technical training practice alongside our work in engineering and community education.

- Design and facilitate workshops in Python, Linux, Git, data processing, and software development practices for learners with different backgrounds.
- Work with clients to understand what participants already know and want to accomplish, then shape realistic learning goals around their context.
- Use guided examples, exercises, and projects to make concepts concrete and give learners room to apply ideas and explain their thinking.
- Adjust pacing and support to the group, drawing on my continuing study of learning science and attention to how new concepts build on what learners already know.

Selected engagement | Contextualized Python training

Four-day organizational workshop | February 2026

Designed and delivered a four-day Python course for participants with different backgrounds. We used projects relevant to their work, guided exercises, discussion, and group activities to explore programming concepts. I also introduced AI-assisted coding while helping learners attend to the concepts needed to understand and evaluate what they produce.

Active Learning, Inc. | JavaScript Trainer

2015–2017 | Part-time

Taught JavaScript within an established training curriculum, preparing demonstrations and exercises and connecting concepts to engineering work. Adjusted the pace and emphasis to what participants already knew.

iACADEMY | Python Instructor

March 2018–June 2019 | Part-time

Designed and taught undergraduate Python electives, including course outcomes and materials. Teaching over successive terms showed me how easily learners can fall behind when a later lesson depends on a concept they have not yet understood. That experience continues to inform how I scaffold learning.

Mentorship and community learning

Save22 | Engineering mentorship and training

Alongside software development, I helped recruit and mentor interns through real engineering work. I prepared their environments and materials, helped them break down tasks, reviewed their work, and supported some as they guided newer interns. I also delivered Python and Flask training with practical examples and exercises.

PythonPH | Co-founder and volunteer leader

2013–present

I have helped create opportunities to learn and lead through meetups, conferences, mentoring, and volunteer work. In regional PyCon events, I worked with local organizers and shared responsibilities and experience as they led in their communities. With Micaela Reyes and other volunteers, I also contributed to Kaizend's work on volunteer development and succession.

Engineering experience

TotalRewards Software, Inc.

Director of Technology | February 2022–present

Lead Developer | October 2017–February 2022

Lead technology direction and engineering work for an enterprise software product. I support engineers as they speak with stakeholders, make technical decisions, document their reasoning, and take ownership of delivery. I continue to investigate problems and implement software.

Save22, Inc. / BOB FTW PTE LTD

Software Developer → Senior Software Developer | April 2013–February 2017

Developed Python and Django systems for retail data acquisition and processing, contributed to architecture and developer workflows, and worked on a hybrid mobile field application.

Earlier engineering work included Python research and development, web applications, telecom data processing, enterprise applications, and systems administration.

Selected learning materials and projects

- Minimal Django: a presentation and step-by-step notes application that introduce Django's structure, walk through a working system, and invite learners to adapt it. github.com/cr8ivecodesmith/djnotes2
- Building Blocks of Data Analytics: a Python notebook using a practical data source, programming fundamentals, and progressively developed questions to explain how analysis is built. github.com/cr8ivecodesmith/pyph_meetup_201810
- Study Utils: personal tools for preparing and exploring study materials and practicing with quizzes. github.com/cr8ivecodesmith/study-utils

Education and recognition

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology | Don Bosco Technical College | 2003–2008

International Society of the Learning Sciences | Member, 2025–present

Uncommon Sense Teaching | Deep Teaching Solutions / Coursera, 2025

Python Software Foundation Fellow | 2019

Python Software Foundation Community Service Award | 2025 | Jointly awarded with Micaela Reyes